

"Thousands of developers in India are focused on Linux and open source projects"

For all those who think open source technology is still not for the masses, read on. **Lux Rao, CTO, Technology Services, HP India**, speaks about how open source technology is going places and job opportunities are increasing by leaps and bounds across this industry. In an exclusive tête-à-tête with **Diksha P Gupta** from **Open Source For You**, Rao shared how developers are hired at companies like HP.



Lux Rao, CTO, Technology Services, HP India

Q Do you feel that India is rich in open source skills?

A India has an enviable pool of open source skills and global-grade talent, which are being leveraged across the globe. Having said that, I would add that we could play a more active role in contributing to the open source community. That would be a true reflection of our skills and talent as a nation.

Q Is this because of the education provided in the country?

A Academia in India is a significant contributor as I believe that students hone their skills on open source thanks to the availability of open source tech, particularly in professional courses such as engineering, and at the Masters level, et al.

Q Do you think there has been an increase in the demand for FOSS professionals over the recent years?

As FOSS continues to leapfrog into the realm of mainstream

adoption, there is an ever increasing demand for FOSS professionals. The future is full of opportunities and it pays to get oneself equipped with open source tech knowledge.

Q Are your clients ready for open source solutions? How has their outlook towards FOSS changed?

I see a marked increase in clients' awareness, understanding and aspirations for FOSS technology. The great values of FOSS cannot be underestimated, and that is not just limited to issues linked to costs or budgets. The notion of a large body of constantly evolving solutions is very compelling and more so as there is a global talent pool at work. All this, and some of the major global successful solutions built around OSS, have stoked the interest around open source.

Added to this is the emergence of new tech stacks by way of the cloud, Big Data, mobility, et al, which are placing huge demands on the scale and agility of organisations. A new style of IT, as mooted by HP, provides choices to clients whilst being cognizant of the opportunities and challenges presented by the emerging ethos of technology.

Q When do you think organisations should opt for FOSS solutions?

The magic of FOSS appeals to organisations of all sizes and at various stages. A start-up would find FOSS compelling due to cost factors, a mid-sized organisation for the tools, and a large organisation for the scale FOSS offers.

Q How do FOSS platforms or tools add value to project development? What are their advantages over proprietary solutions?

I think one of the key advantages of using FOSS tools is that there is a large amount of work that is constantly going in to building open source technology. So, with open source technology, you can leverage global expertise and get the best-of-the-breed applicable to your requirements. In a way, what you are doing is leveraging the global development talent pool, without the costs normally incurred to come up with something that actually brings a lot of value to your project. The advantage of open source technology is that the developers get to access the latest and the best tools, which helps them do their work better. There are a variety of tools to choose from in the open source